

NR2DT-08: Step 8 — Validate

Series: NR2DT | **Notebook:** 8 of 10 | **Created:** April 2026 | **Last Updated:** 04/14/2026

Overview

Goal of this step: run the three-tier validation across every migrated artifact. Syntax, tenant, and behavioral checks must all pass before cutover.

Procedural — see **NRLC-08** (Validation, Diff & Rollback) for the validation theory and tooling depth.

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Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Audience	Migration lead + assigned engineer for this step
Completed	NR2DT-07 — Migrate Logs, Tags & Drops
Format	Procedural step — use as a runbook; defer to NRLC for depth
NRLC deep dives	NRLC-08 (Validation deep dive)

1. Three-Tier Validation Pass

Tier 1 — Syntax

Already done in Step 4 for queries; re-run for any changed artifacts:

```
python3 migrate.py validate --tier syntax --components all
```

Tier 2 — Tenant

Confirm referenced metrics, entities, buckets, and OpenPipeline enrichment attributes exist:

```
python3 migrate.py validate --tier tenant --components all
```

Common Tier 2 failures:

- Migrated alert references a metric the tenant doesn't ingest
- DQL filter on `environment` attribute that no enrichment rule produces
- Synthetic location `AWS_US_EAST_1` not enabled in this tenant

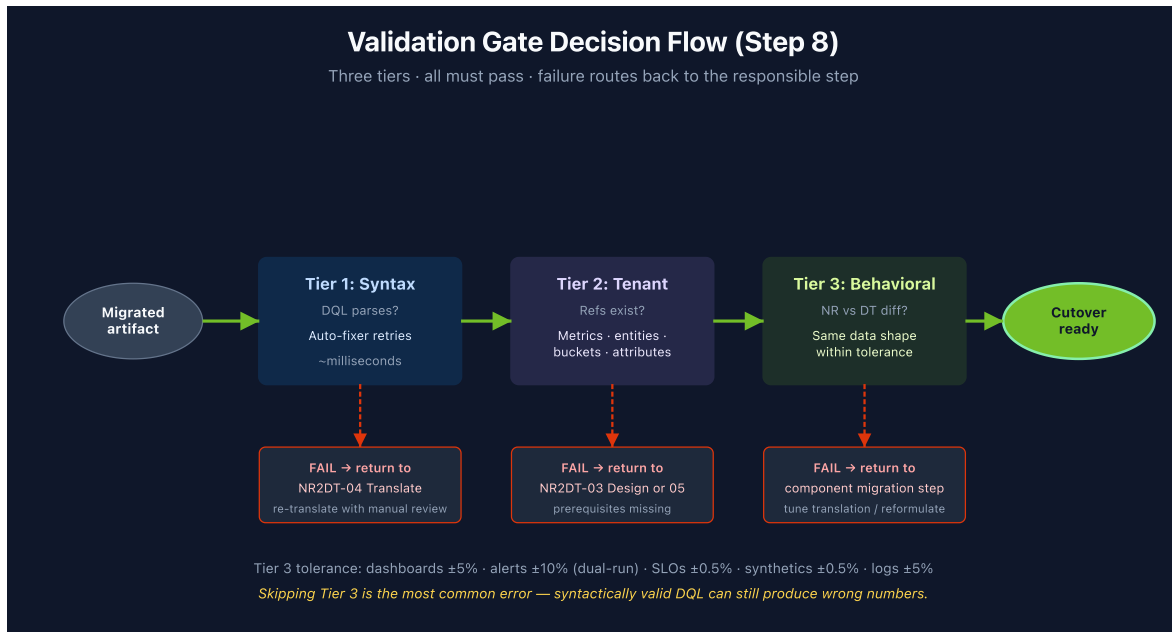
Tier 3 — Behavioral

Compare NR vs. DT outputs across the dual-run window:

```
python3 migrate.py compare --components dashboards,alerts,slos --window 7d
```

Tolerance per artifact:

Artifact	Tolerance
Dashboards	±5%
Alerts (dual-run volume)	±10%
SLOs	±0.5%
Synthetics	±0.5%
Log volumes	±5%



2. Diff Against Live Config

Confirm no drift since import:

```
python3 migrate.py --diff --components all
```

Investigate any `EXISTING_DRIFT` entries — someone manually changed a migrated artifact in DT. Decide whether the change should be incorporated into the migration source-of-truth (Terraform), reverted, or accepted.

3. Generate the Quality Report

```
python3 migrate.py --report --output validation-report.html
```

Report sections:

- Per-component pass/fail counts
- Failed translations (with reasons)
- Manual-review queue (APM conditions, scripted browsers, deferred queries)
- Rollback-eligible entities (within retention window)
- Recommended next actions

Attach this report to the cutover change-management ticket.

4. Step Exit Criteria

G6 — Cutover Ready

- [] Tier 1 (syntax) — all components pass
- [] Tier 2 (tenant) — all references resolve
- [] Tier 3 (behavioral) — all artifacts within tolerance
- [] Diff report shows no unexpected drift
- [] Quality report attached to cutover ticket
- [] Stakeholders briefed on remaining manual-review items

Next step: NR2DT-09 — Cutover, Rollback & Decommission.

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